Who Does What in the Okafor Lab

Roles, contacts, escalation paths and the Fall 2026 chore rota

Maintained by Marisol Vega, Lab Manager · Fall 2026 edition, issued 21 September 2026 · Rota valid 28 Sep – 18 Dec 2026

1. People

Name	Role	Room	Phone	Email
Prof. Adaeze Okafor	Principal Investigator (PI)	418	x4410	aokafor@westbrook.edu
Marisol Vega	Lab Manager	414	x4412	mvega@westbrook.edu
Dr. Tomasz Brenner	Senior Postdoc; **Lab Safety Officer**	417	x4415	tbrenner@westbrook.edu
Dr. Priya Raghunathan	Postdoc (protein biochemistry)	417	x4416	praghunathan@westbrook.edu
Dr. Lucas Ferreira	Postdoc; cryo-EM liaison	417	x4417	lferreira@westbrook.edu
Hannah Lindqvist	Graduate student, year 5	417	x4419	hlindqvist@westbrook.edu
Daniel Osei	Graduate student, year 4	417	x4419	dosei@westbrook.edu
Mei-Ling Zhou	Graduate student, year 3	417	x4419	mzhou@westbrook.edu
Rafael Castaño	Graduate student, year 2	417	x4419	rcastano@westbrook.edu
Aisha Bello	Graduate student, year 2	417	x4419	abello@westbrook.edu
Jordan Pike	Undergraduate researcher	417	x4419	jpike@westbrook.edu
Sofia Marchetti	Undergraduate researcher	417	x4419	smarchetti@westbrook.edu
Ethan Park	Rotation student (14 Sep – 20 Nov 2026)	417	x4419	epark@westbrook.edu

Whole-lab email list: okaforlab@westbrook.edu. x4419 is the shared phone in the student/postdoc office (417). Out-of-hours mobile numbers for the freezer-alarm call tree are in *After Hours and Special Materials*. The second rotation student of the term ("R2" in the rota) joins on 23 November.

2. Responsibilities

PI (Adaeze Okafor). Scientific direction and project assignments; approves orders of $250 or more and all equipment purchases; authorship decisions; PI of record on the lab's biosafety registration and animal protocol; approves repairs over $500; final say on anything not covered elsewhere.

Lab Manager (Marisol Vega). Ordering and receiving; budgets and chartstrings; equipment service contracts and repairs; card access, keys and accounts; freezer inventory and first contact for -80 ℃ freezer alarms; the stockroom account; the chore rota; onboarding and exit checklists; **all shipping**, including anything shipped on dry ice and any biological material (these are regulated shipments, so Marisol prepares and signs the paperwork; never ship things yourself). Anything administrative not covered in this packet (payroll, HR questions, department paperwork) also starts with Marisol, who will point you to the right person in the MCB department office.

Lab Safety Officer (Tomasz Brenner). Lab-specific safety orientation; countersigns tissue culture sign-offs; monthly lab self-inspection (first Monday of each month); spill kits and eyewash checks; chemical inventory; liquid nitrogen hands-on training; incident and near-miss reports and liaison with Westbrook EHS; schedules the annual biosafety cabinet certification with Mei-Ling.

Equipment owners. One person per major instrument. The owner trains and signs off new users (and marks them as trained in MCB-Book), keeps the logbook and the SOP up to date, is the first contact when something goes wrong, and coordinates repairs with Marisol.

3. Equipment owners

Instrument / area	Location	Owner (trains you)	Backup
AKTA FPLC	416A (cold room)	Priya Raghunathan	Lucas Ferreira
Floor ultracentrifuge and rotors	415	Daniel Osei	Tomasz Brenner
Multimode plate reader	415	Aisha Bello	Hannah Lindqvist
NanoDrop spectrophotometer	415	Aisha Bello	Rafael Castaño
qPCR machine (96-well)	415	Rafael Castaño	Mei-Ling Zhou
Gel and blot imager	415	Lucas Ferreira	Hannah Lindqvist
Probe sonicator	412B	Priya Raghunathan	Daniel Osei
Biosafety cabinets and CO_2 incubators	413 (TC room)	Mei-Ling Zhou	Hannah Lindqvist
-80 ℃ freezers A, B and C	416	Marisol Vega	Tomasz Brenner
Liquid nitrogen dewars, cell-line cryostorage	416	Tomasz Brenner	Mei-Ling Zhou
Autoclave (shared with the Nakamura Lab)	Keller 420	Marisol Vega	Facilities
Confocal microscope (core facility)	Hartley 210	Core staff; lab contact Hannah Lindqvist	–
Cryo-EM sample prep (facility)	Sato Center 150	Facility staff; lab contact Lucas Ferreira	–

4. Who to ask for what

If you need…	Ask
To order something, or you can't find a reagent	Check the inventories first, then Marisol (#orders)
Card access, keys, accounts, a desk	Marisol
Help with, or training on, an instrument	The instrument's owner (table above)
A safety question, or to report a spill, exposure or near miss	Tomasz. **In an emergency call 911 first.**
Advice on an experiment or protocol	Your day-to-day mentor, then subgroup meeting
A decision about your project, priorities or authorship	Adaeze (bring it to your 1:1, or email for urgent items)
A freezer alarm going off	Follow the call tree in *After Hours and Special Materials*
Anything administrative not listed here	Marisol

5. Escalation paths

- **Equipment problem:** owner → backup owner → Marisol → Adaeze (repairs over $500 need PI approval). Label a broken instrument "DO NOT USE" with the date and your name, and post in #equipment.
- **Safety:** immediate danger or injury → **911** → Tomasz → Adaeze → Westbrook EHS. Non-urgent concerns go to Tomasz, or anonymously to the EHS concern line (555-0165).
- **Interpersonal issues or conflict:** if you feel able to, talk with the person directly → your mentor or Adaeze → the MCB Head Graduate Advisor (Dr. Ruth Albright, x4001) or the Westbrook Ombuds Office (555-0180). You can go straight to the later steps at any time.

6. Chores: what each one involves

Autoclave

Run biohazard waste loads on Monday, Wednesday and Friday by 11:00 in Keller 420; run the dirty-glassware load; restock autoclave bags and indicator tape; log every run (date, cycle, load, initials) in the autoclave log and check that the indicator tape has changed colour.

Waste

Swap full biohazard bins in 412 and 413; close and replace sharps containers that are three-quarters full; check the chemical waste satellite accumulation area (under the 412 fume hood) every Friday, and request an EHS pickup online for any container that is three-quarters full.

LN_2 fill

LN_2-trained people only. Tuesday and Friday mornings: top up storage dewars 1 and 2 from the supply dewar and record levels; tell Marisol if the supply dewar is below 30%. Follow the after-hours buddy rule in *After Hours and Special Materials*.

-80 check

Monday to Friday: record the temperature of freezers A, B and C on the log sheet on each door and check the alarm battery light. Friday: clear ice from the door gaskets. Report anything above -75 °C to Marisol.

Media prep

TC-trained people only. Monday: prepare six 500 mL bottles each of complete DMEM and complete RPMI (recipe in the TC SOP), label with date and initials, set aside a 5 mL sterility check for 48 h, record in the media log.

Eyewash

Flush the eyewash stations in 412, 413 and 415 for 3 minutes, initial the tag, and check that the spill kits are stocked. Report problems to Tomasz. (Safety showers are tested monthly by Facilities, not by us.)

7. Chore rota, Fall 2026

Weeks run Monday to Friday. The person listed is responsible for the whole week.

Week of	Autoclave	Waste	LN_2 fill	-80 check	Media prep	Eyewash
28 Sep	JP	AB	PR	DO	HL	SM
5 Oct	SM	HL	LF	MZ	RC	EP
12 Oct	EP	DO	TB	AB	MZ	JP
19 Oct	RC	MZ	HL	JP	AB	LF
26 Oct	AB	SM	DO	EP	TB	PR
2 Nov	JP	EP	MZ	RC	HL	SM
9 Nov	SM	MZ	PR	HL	RC	EP
16 Nov	EP	JP	LF	SM	MZ	AB
23 Nov*	HL	RC	TB	SM	AB	JP
30 Nov	R2	AB	HL	DO	MZ	RC
7 Dec	DO	R2	PR	JP	HL	LF
14 Dec	MZ	SM	LF	R2	RC	PR

*Thanksgiving week: the building is closed Thursday 26 and Friday 27 November. Autoclave runs on Monday and Wednesday only; -80 checks Monday to Wednesday. A skeleton rota for the winter closure (from 19 December) will be posted in early December.

Key. TB Tomasz Brenner · PR Priya Raghunathan · LF Lucas Ferreira · HL Hannah Lindqvist · DO Daniel Osei · MZ Mei-Ling Zhou · RC Rafael Castaño · AB Aisha Bello · JP Jordan Pike · SM Sofia Marchetti · EP Ethan Park (rotation student) · R2 second rotation student of the term (from 23 Nov).

Rota rules

- **Swaps** are fine. Arrange the swap yourself, update the rota file (`okafor-nas/admin/rota_fall2026.xlsx`) and post it in #general.
- **Away that week?** It is your job to find a swap before you leave, not Marisol's.
- **Trained-only chores.** LN_2 fill needs Tomasz's hands-on LN_2 sign-off; media prep needs the TC sign-off. Undergraduates and rotation students are not assigned these.
- **Missed chores** affect everybody (an unrun autoclave means overflowing biohazard bins). If something prevents you from doing yours, tell Marisol the same day.